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SureETMF™

Improving Clinical Trial ROI with Automation

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Improving Clinical Trial ROI with Automation

Executive Summary

Clinical trials are burdened with mountains of paper and manual processes. The labor costs involved in the manual processes of collecting, completing, classifying and reviewing investigator documents are significant and are a significant cost driver in clinical trials. However, leading BioPharma organizations are increasingly using collaborative cloud computing and portal based application solutions to create, digitally sign and complete documents in the cloud through automated processes called workflows. Workflow task automation helps to eliminate paper at the point of origination, reducing or eliminating the need for labor intensive processes like document printing and filing, scanning, manual tagging and classification. With automated workflows, clinical trial operations can realize significant cost and time savings while realizing higher levels of clinical trial data management quality, process compliance, reporting and auditability.

SureClinical offers next generation collaborative cloud, portal-based applications that can be used by all stakeholders in a clinical trial project – study sponsors, clinical research organizations, investigators, auditors and data providers. SureClinical is the only clinical trial eTMF applications provider to offer the ability to organizations to create, digitally sign and complete documents entirely in the cloud with FDA and EC compliant Adobe® digital ID's, eliminating paper at the point of origination for clinical trial operations. SureClinical's cloud applications are accessible across web and mobile devices, providing anytime, anywhere access to global teams to complete tasks on time and on schedule through a simple and easy to use wizard based web portal. By empowering the entire clinical stakeholder team with access to cloud based portals and task completion with automated workflows, manual processes can be reduced or eliminated. As a result of task automation, enhanced clinical trial project management, comprehensive task tracking, milestone management and oversight are possible, accelerating clinical trial project completion.

> According to AIIM, the global community of information professionals, "60% of users have seen ROI on their paper-free projects within 12 months, an impressive 77% within 18 months.
>
> Faster response and higher productivity are seen as the biggest benefits, along with improved remote and mobile availability."
>
> *—2014 AIIM Market Intelligence Report, 'Paper Wars'*

COLLABORATIVE CLOUD PORTALS ENHANCE CLINICAL TRIAL OPERATIONS

In the fast-paced BioPharma business environment, collaborative cloud computing is gaining traction, providing enterprises with a means to improve operational efficiency and accelerate time to market. Collaborative cloud computing is at the center of a movement in the software industry to build functionally rich and vertically-focused solutions that can extend the power of enterprise computing beyond the firewall to include external business partners, in what is commonly referred to as Extraprise collaborative cloud computing.

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Collaborative processes play a role in almost every part of your business – from clinical trial research and development, clinical trial study startup to product marketing. The applications and technology infrastructure you use are essential to leverage and integrate the work of your entire internal and external clinical trial team, including sponsors, CROs, investigators, academic research organizations and other clinical trial partners.

Although cloud computing applications are only beginning to be adopted by life sciences companies, industry analysts predict that cloud-based, collaborative clinical trial portals will be used extensively to accelerate clinical trial development, reduce clinical trial study costs, enhance clinical trial operations efficiency and improve quality. Clinical trial portals provide a centralized point of collaboration to complete tasks online. By utilizing new technologies such as integrated digital signing, portal users can collaboratively create, review and digitally sign documents entirely online, eliminating the cost and waste of manually printing, scanning, uploading, tagging and classifying documents.

SureClinical sees collaborative cloud applications, clinical trial portals and automated workflows as a means of ensuring process consistency, efficiency and enhanced regulatory compliance. Automated workflows with integrated digital signing technologies enable portal-based team collaboration and document completion across web, mobile and desktop platforms for centralized management, tracking, reporting, auditing and quality management. In addition to the cost and time savings of automated processes over manual processes, automated workflows and automated task completion can enhance your ability to comply with global FDA, HIPAA, EU and other regulatory agency requirements through enhanced process monitoring and oversight.

REQUIREMENTS FOR COLLABORATIVE CLOUD PORTALS WITH TASK AUTOMATION

Collaborative cloud portals are used in clinical trial regulatory document management to connect people, organizations, and clinical trial applications and study content in a standards-based, compliant, secure environment. Instead of manually processing clinical trial documents using time-consuming tasks such as printing, signing, and scanning, today's cloud-based applications simplify and automate tasks by enabling users and clinical trial partners to complete documents entirely in the cloud using task automation, otherwise known as workflows.

> Two thirds of users recognize the importance of mobile devices for content access and data capture.
>
> *—2014 AIIM Market Intelligence Report, 'Paper Wars'*

Companies are embracing collaborative cloud computing solutions that enable secure information sharing and FDA and EU agency compliant digital signatures on documents. This facilitates document completion beyond the corporate firewall with business partners, fundamentally transforming the way that clinical trials are conducted. Best-in-class collaborative cloud applications allow users from multiple organizations to collaboratively review, digitally sign and complete documents through a centralized, standards-based, collaborative cloud application that is secure and compliant. The shared cloud portal approach generates economies of scale that reduces costs, accelerates new drug delivery times and facilitates global business organizational agility and flexibility.

To realize these benefits, BioPharma organizations are deploying collaborative cloud solutions that connect global clinical trial teams together seamlessly within a compliant, standards-based environment.

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Collaborative cloud portals need to be able to provide an enterprise-level solution that can do the following:

- Quickly connect teams of sponsors, CROs and investigators in a secure portal with a role-based experience, available on mobile phones, tablets and web devices
- Eliminate paper-based processes with digital signing and automated document workflows to better manage data
- Track essential document milestone completion with reporting and audit trails for compliance and quality
- Improve collaboration and document exchange capabilities to accelerate the flow of information between stakeholders
- Support standards-based technologies to facilitate interoperability with existing systems

CLINICAL TRIAL TASK AUTOMATION WITH WORKFLOWS

A key system requirement for any organization who wants to automate clinical trial task completion would include integrated support for completing tasks through a secure portal using workflow automation. A workflow is simply a series of tasks that are part of a business process. As an example, sending a document for someone to sign is an example of a basic workflow process. Workflows can be used to consistently manage common clinical trial processes within an organization. Instead of manually performing tasks such as document signing, review and classification, organizations specify a set of tasks, documents, instructions and the persons to complete a process. The eClinical application software then completes the task automatically.

Workflows can streamline the cost and time required to coordinate common clinical trial processes, such as document review, approval and digital signing, by managing and tracking the human tasks involved with these processes. For example, with SureClinical eTMF, you can create a workflow from our eClinical workflow library that routes a protocol signature document to a group of principal investigators for review and digital signature.

The study administrator starts this workflow by selecting the protocol signature document or form from the eTMF system, then specifies the list of principal investigators (workflow recipients) who need to review and sign the document. The system creates and launches the workflow and sends email task notification alerts to the participants with task instructions and a link to the document to be reviewed and digitally signed. While the workflow is in progress, the workflow initiator (in this case, the study administrator) or the workflow participants can check the Workflow dashboard page to see which participants have completed their workflow tasks. When the workflow participants complete their workflow tasks, the workflow ends, and the workflow owner is automatically notified that the workflow has completed.

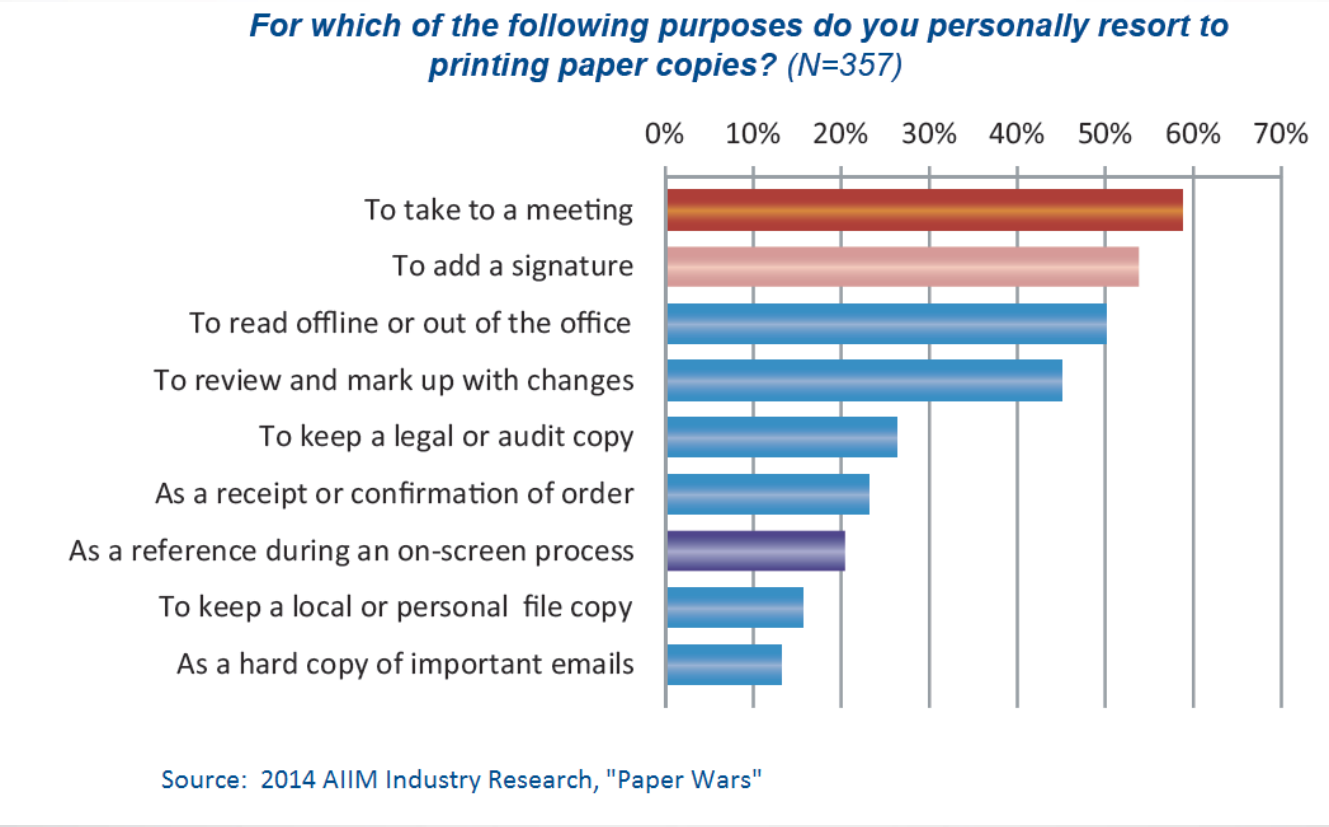
Contact SureClinical to have one of our consultants perform a free estimate of your study's current paper-based costs compared to your estimated eTMF costs using eClinical workflows and our FDA/EC compliant Adobe digital signing.

SureClinical provides the only eClinical collaborative cloud portal, applications and platform that has integrated workflows with integrated Adobe digital signing. SureClinical provides a library of customizable eClinical workflows, allowing organizations the flexibility to create, execute and completed organization specific eClinical workflows. Detailed audit trails, reporting and dashboards provide visibility and control over workflow processes and tasks.

CLINICAL TRIAL PROCESS AUTOMATION – BEST PRACTICES

As clinical trial organizations contemplate implementation of systems and portals that can automate clinical trial tasks such as essential document collection, it's important to first benchmark and summarize existing manual paper-based clinical trial processes. After benchmarking existing processes and outlining the key objectives, documents and resources, persons, steps and decision points that comprise existing processes, organizations can create an optimized series of automated task steps that map automate tasks to existing manual tasks. These automated task steps are then completed through an automated workflow process.

Key factors to assess when deploying a workflow include ease of use, ease of access by stakeholders with support from popular mobile and web devices, ease of deployment, ease of administration, security, collaboration and regulatory compliance.



To help illustrate how organizations can recognize enhanced return on investment for its clinical trial operations, on the next few pages we'll outline a few examples of best practices to automated common clinical trial document collection tasks in clinical trials.

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Example 1 – Review and Sign Monitoring Trip Report

Existing Clinical Operations Process Example (existing paper based, manual process)

A clinical trial associate (CRA) who monitors clinical investigator sites creates a monitoring trip report for each site visit. The draft trip report is sent via email to the clinical trial project manager. The project manager reads the trip report, comments on it, and sends any comments back to the CRA via email in the form of MS Word document comments. The CRA makes required changes, and then prints it, signs it, scans it and then emails it for signature to the project manager for final approval and signature. If the report is acceptable, the project manager prints, signs and scans the trip report. The final trip report is then emailed to the study administrator who prints and files the report in a fireproof file cabinet. Alternatively, original signed trip report is mailed to the study project manager for final signature and the paper original is filed.

Issues: Manual emailing of sensitive documents (monitoring trip report), multiple manual signing including manual printing, scanning, emailing of documents; manual filing of final documents. Possibility for multiple wet-signature pages and confusion over electronic versions vs. paper version. No centralized tracking or audit trail, manual tracking of signed documents in MS Excel spreadsheet or other manual index.

Total time and labor to perform process: 10 hours per trip report, not including actual report writing time

Automated Process Example (using SureClinical's workflow process and digital signing)

Using a standard SureClinical Review Document and Sign eClinical workflow process, a document is shared by the CRA to the project manager as a web sharable link created from the CRA's mobile phone, tablet or laptop. The CRA and the project manager collaboratively comment on draft documents online via the web portal and the CRA completes any edits to the trip report and presents it to the manager for final approval. When a final version of the document is accepted by the project manager, both the CRA and the project manager can digitally sign the document online from their mobile phones without printing or scanning. Both signatures can be applied to a single page of the trip report in which ever signing order is preferred (manager first, CRA second, etc.) Upon completion of the monitor trip report workflow process, the workflow participants receive a notification email, a visual indicator on their dashboard and a report outlining who completed the task. All digitally signed copies of the document are automatically tagged, classified and stored in SureClinical's Certified Cloud™.

Using this automated approach, large groups of global CRA teams can submit trip reports for efficient review, online collaboration and digital signing on a predefined schedule in the field without the need to find a printer or a scanner. Gantt charts and reports continuously track progress of training material completion, while an audit trail captures and monitors actions of the process participants.

SureClinical eClinical Workflow used: Review and Sign Document: Monitoring Trip Report

Total time and labor to perform process: 10 min per trip report (actual processing time)

Time savings as a percent (automated vs. manual) = **98.33%**

Example 2 – Collect Essential Study docs and Sign

Existing Clinical Operations Process Example (existing paper based, manual process)

Prior to engaging with patients on a clinical trial, clinicians and clinical trial investigator sites must submit regulatory documents to a project manager at the clinical trial sponsor or clinical research organization. A clinical trial project manager has a list of required 'essential documents' that need to be collected from each clinical investigator site. Typical essential documents include a medical license, a curriculum vitae, a financial disclosure and other regulatory documents. Often these essential documents need to be signed by the investigator. With the manual approach, often the study project manager emails the clinical trial investigator site a list of required documents and an express delivery account number or provides an overnight mail envelope for submission of the essential documents. The documents are printed, signed and overnight mailed to the study project manager. They may also be printed, scanned and emailed back to the project manager. The project manager takes each site's documents (sometimes there are 50 or more sites), scans them and saves them on a shared drive on the internal network. The project manager compiles a manual list of each document received using an MS Excel sheet or other manual method. If a document such as a license is missing, there is a manual exception process whereby the project manager needs to send a reminder email to the investigator site and perhaps a second overnight mailing envelop or account number. If a license or other document expires during the course of the study, the project manager may be unaware and the site is out of compliance. When the final documents are eventually collected for each site they are stored in a fireproof file cabinet.

Issues: Manual tracking of required and expiring documents for multiple investigator sites and clinicians, manual mailing and overnight costs, managing manual reminder emails to multiple investigator sites. Manual filing of final documents. No centralized tracking or audit trail. Manual tracking of completed and expiring documents in MS Excel spreadsheet or other manual index.

Total time and labor to perform process: 15 hours per study site; 15 documents/site

Automated Process Example (using SureClinical's workflow process and digital signing)

Using a standard SureClinical Upload and Sign Document eClinical workflow process for essential documents, a list of required documents is shared by the clinical study project manager as a web sharable link to the study coordinator at the investigator site. The study coordinator is requested to upload documents to the web portal. As uploaded documents are available for review, approval and signature by the clinician, the clinician gets an email notification that a document is awaiting review and signature. The clinician can digitally sign the document online from their mobile phone, tablet or laptop without printing or scanning. Upon completion of the Upload and Sign Document workflow process, the study administrator receives a notification email that all essential documents are completed, a visual indicator on their dashboard and a report outlining who completed the task. All digitally signed copies of the document are automatically tagged, classified and stored in SureClinical's Certified Cloud™.

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Using this automated approach, large groups of global clinical investigator sites can submit completed essential documents in minutes instead of weeks. Gantt charts and reports continuously track progress of training material completion, while an audit trail captures and monitors actions of the process participants.

SureClinical eClinical Workflow used: Upload and Sign Document: Essential documents

Total time and labor to perform process: 1 hour per study site (actual processing time)

Time savings as a percent (automated vs. manual) = **93.33%**

Example 3 – Distribute Training Materials for Review and Signature

Existing Clinical Operations Process Example (existing paper based, manual process)

An SOP is sent manually via email to 25 clinical trial staff members. Each staff member reads the SOP, prints, and signs a training record and then scans the training record for emailing back to the training administrator. The study admin downloads each signed training record document from their email, and then uploads the document to their internal shared drive or prints and files a paper copy.

Issues: Manual emailing of sensitive documents (SOPs), manual uploading and tagging, no centralized tracking or audit trail, manual tracking of signed documents in MS Excel spreadsheet or other manual index.

Total time and labor to perform process: 25 hours, not including actual training time

Automated Process Example (using SureClinical's workflow process and digital signing)

Using a standard SureClinical review form and sign eClinical workflow process, an SOP training document is shared with persons or groups as a web sharable link via a web portal by the study administrator. Each person gets an individual copy of the same document for their review and signature. Upon completion of the SOP training material review step by the participants, a digital signing task is automatically launched for each person to sign their copy of the SOP (or accompanying training record). When the review and sign document workflow process is completed, the study administrator receives a notification email, a visual indicator on their dashboard and a report outlining who completed the task. All digitally signed copies of the document are automatically tagged, classified and stored in SureClinical's Certified Cloud™.

Using this automated approach, large groups of global teams can review, digitally sign and complete required training materials on a predefined schedule. Gantt charts and reports continuously track progress of training material completion, while an audit trail captures and monitors actions of the process participants.

SureClinical eClinical Workflow used: Review and Sign Form: Training document

Total time and labor to perform automated process: 2 hours

Time savings as a percent (automated vs. manual) = **92%**

Conclusion

Workflow task automation helps to eliminate paper at the point of origination, reducing or eliminating the need for labor intensive processes like document printing and filing, scanning, manual tagging and classification. With automated workflows, clinical trial operations can realize significant cost and time savings while realizing higher levels of clinical trial data management quality, process compliance, reporting and auditability.

Based on the example clinical trial process scenarios outlined, organizations who utilize automated systems with to collect clinical trial documents could recognize an average time savings of nearly 90% over manual approaches. These estimates assume deployment of a collaborative cloud mobile-ready portal, automated workflows with integrated digital signing to all stakeholders on the clinical trial team .

SureClinical offers next generation collaborative cloud, portal-based applications that can be used by all stakeholders in a clinical trial project – study sponsors, clinical research organizations, investigators, auditors and data providers. SureClinical is the only clinical trial eTMF applications provider to offer the ability to organizations to create, digitally sign and complete documents entirely in the cloud with FDA and EC compliant Adobe® digital ID's, eliminating paper at the point of origination for clinical trial operations. SureClinical's cloud applications are accessible across web and mobile devices, providing anytime, anywhere access to global teams to complete tasks on time and on schedule through a simple and easy to use wizard based web portal.

SureClinical - Ensuring Success for Clinical Operations

SureClinical's Network, Applications and Platform are independently FDA Part 11, EC Annex 11, GAMP5 and HIPAA compliance validated solutions that automate the acquisition, classification, signing, auditing, and archiving of clinical study regulatory documents. An efficient Software as a Service (SaaS) solution, SureClinical can be activated in minutes, accerating study startup. The SureClinical solution generates an immediate ROI by eliminating paper-based processes, saving valuable time, energy, and dollars.

Free eTMF Return on Investment Consultation

Our team of experts is prepared to work with you to estimate your current TMF costs and the estimated savings and total return on investment using the SureClinical eTMF Certified Cloud. Take advantage of this valuable consultation by contacting us today!

Contact SureClinical today!

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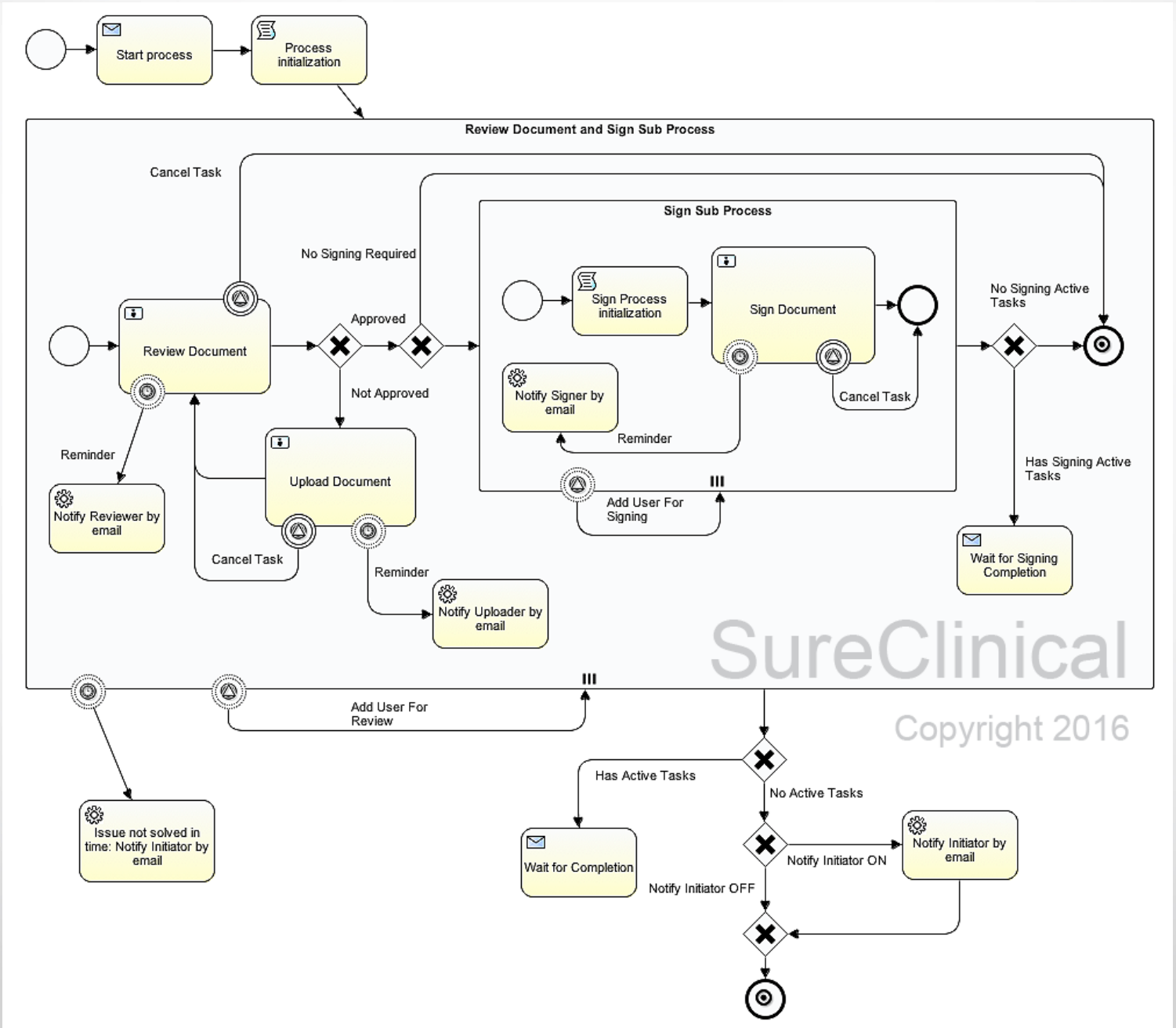
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Appendix

Process diagrams of the eClinical workflow tasks that were used to in the examples above are illustrated below using business process modeling notation (BPMN). Contact SureClinical for assistance in developing your own workflow automation processes today.

Example 1 – Review and Sign Monitoring Trip Report

SureClinical eClinical Workflow used: Review and Sign Document

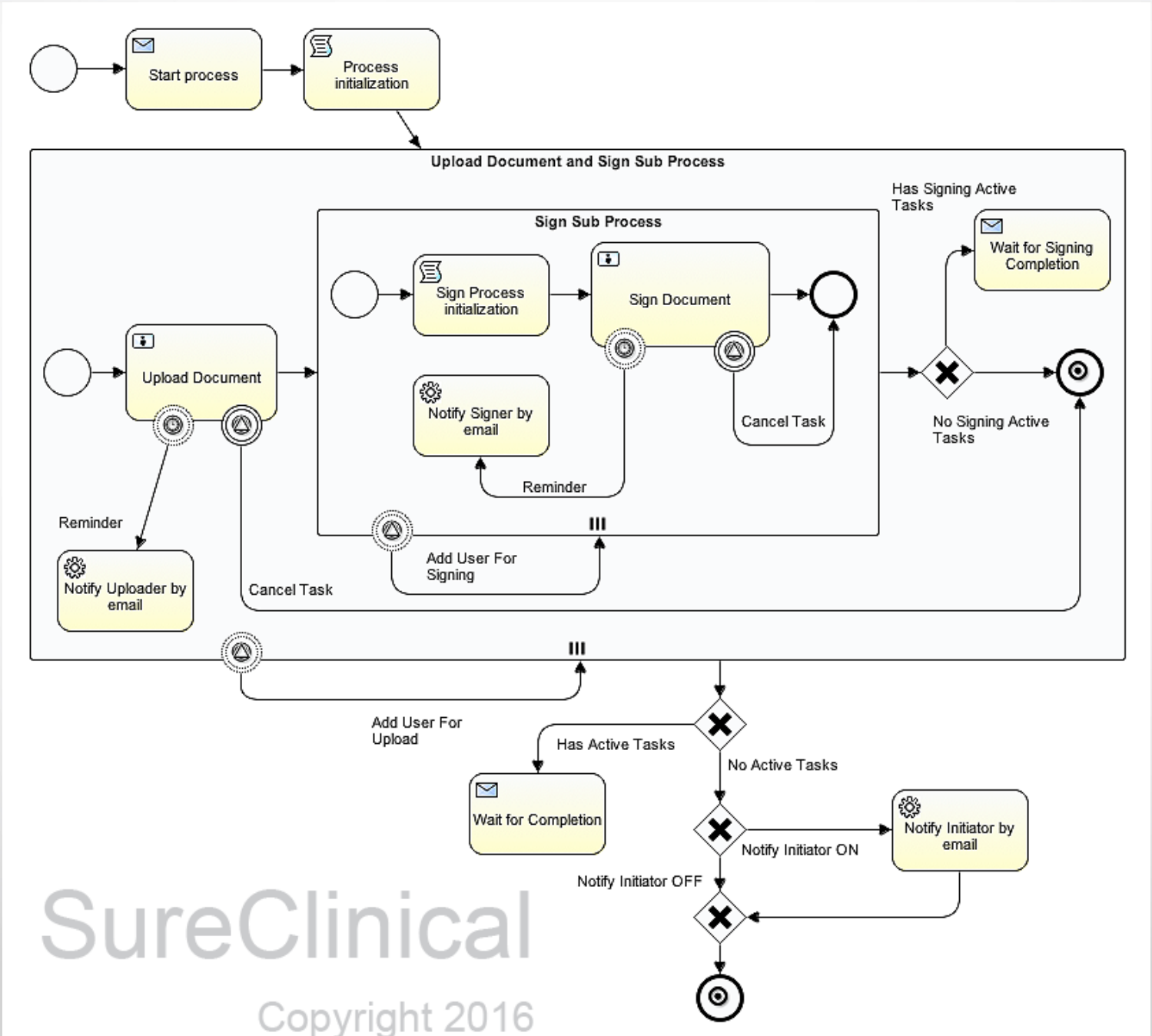


Appendix

Process diagrams of the eClinical workflow tasks that were used to in the examples above are illustrated below using business process modeling notation (BPMN). Contact SureClinical for assistance in developing your own workflow automation processes today.

Example 2 – Collect Essential Study docs and Sign

SureClinical eClinical Workflow used: Upload and Sign Document



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Process diagrams of the eClinical workflow tasks that were used to in the examples above are illustrated below using business process modeling notation (BPMN). Contact SureClinical for assistance in developing your own workflow automation processes today.

Example 3 – Distribute Training Materials for Review and Signature

SureClinical eClinical Workflow used: Review and Sign Form

